Butter or cream stirred into a soup at the last minute will greatly improve its character, adding body and shine. For interest, you can flavor the butter and serve it at the table.

enriching

Both cream and butter make a quick and simple garnish for individual servings of soup (see pp36–39), but if you have another garnish in mind, you can add them to the soup to enrich it while it's still in the pan. Butters flavored with herbs, nuts, or smoked fish are another way of enriching a soup, although these are best served separately, to be added to the soup by your guests.

with cream



Add the cream at the end of cooking and, in a puréed soup, after blending. Stir it in well, then check the seasoning. If you've added a substantial amount of cream, you may want to reheat the soup gently before serving.

with butter



Cut 1 tbsp of chilled unsalted butter into cubes. Remove the pan from the heat and whisk it in a cube at a time—the soup should become glossy and smooth. Do not reheat the soup or the butter will separate.